WE ARE M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

SOUNDCLOUD YOUTUBE CAMPAIGN

SOUNDCLOUD + YouTube

Holistic strategy meets tactical optimizations.

SoundCloud is a leading audio distribution and music sharing platform that allows users to upload, promote, and stream audio. Artists such as Billie Eilish, Post Malone, Khalid, and Lorde use SoundCloud's services to launch music and grow their followers.

The SoundCloud app offers both free and paid subscription services to customers. For artists, there is a paid subscription to enable them to connect to fans. Business challenges include user acquisition and competing with some top players in the music streaming space (Spotify).

We have been working with SoundCloud since Q2 2021 in order to bring new users to the platform. Initially we only worked on Programmatic for SoundCloud, but as of January 2022, M&C Saatchi Performance become the digital agency of record for the brand, and we are now responsible for paid media acquisition campaigns driving user growth in both 'Fan' and 'Artist' audiences.

We are continuing to work with SoundCloud to build strategies that lead to efficient growth across web and app campaigns. For example, YouTube is a strategic channel for SoundCloud and the campaigns required optimization, which is where we stepped in.

STRATEGY

THE BRIEF:

YouTube is an acquisition channel for Artist campaigns. However, the campaigns required optimization to ensure that KPIs (Cost per Acquisition) were being met. YouTube is ‘always-on’ for SoundCloud but was not meeting expectations.

THE CHALLENGE:

The inherited YouTube campaigns had multiple events being measured, which meant that KPIs were including conversion metrics that should not have been included and were therefore inflating results.

THE STRATEGY:

We looked at audience targeting strategies to optimize the audiences available and ensured measurement was accurate.

In addition to these new audience tactics, we knew varied creative would make a powerful difference in what the YouTube algorithm would optimize toward.

THE CAMPAIGN

We understood that YouTube was an important acquisition channel for Artist campaigns, being able to convey the SoundCloud value proposition directly to budding artists and show them that SoundCloud is a platform to be seen on.

We reviewed the audience targeting opportunities available to us and any 1st party data points that the client was able to provide. These were used to create Retargeting and Look-a-Like audiences, which would provide an opportunity for improved results.

In addition to these new audience tactics, we knew varied creative would make a powerful difference in what the YouTube algorithm would optimize toward.

By providing the campaigns with both new audiences and new targeted assets, we were able to achieve the lowest CPA of the channel's history.

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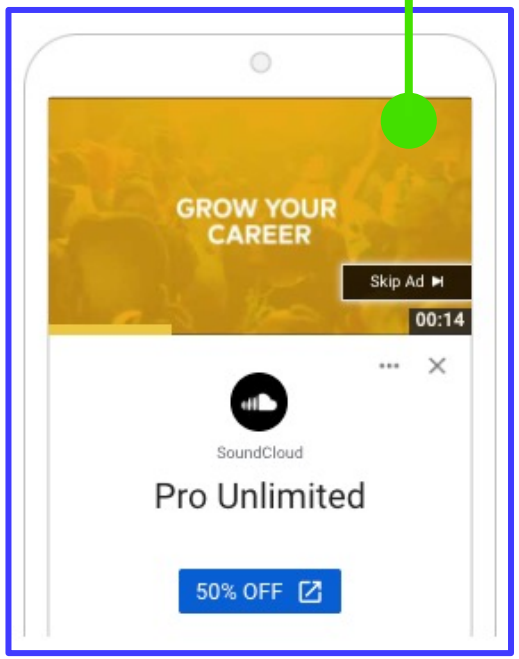
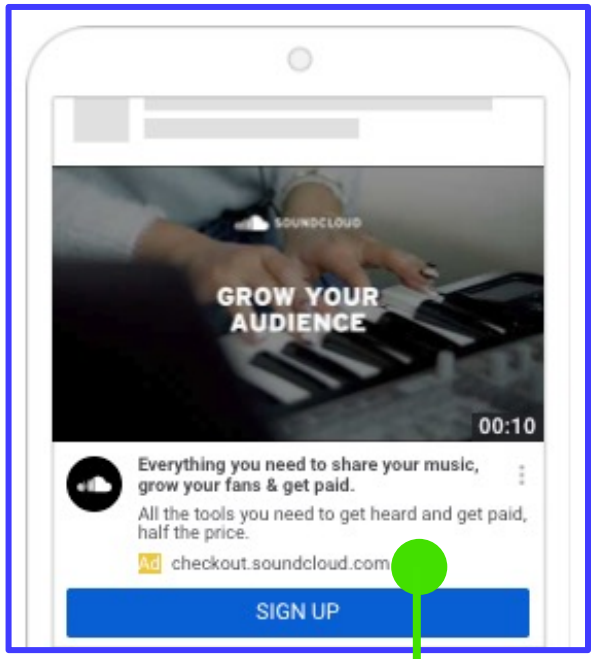
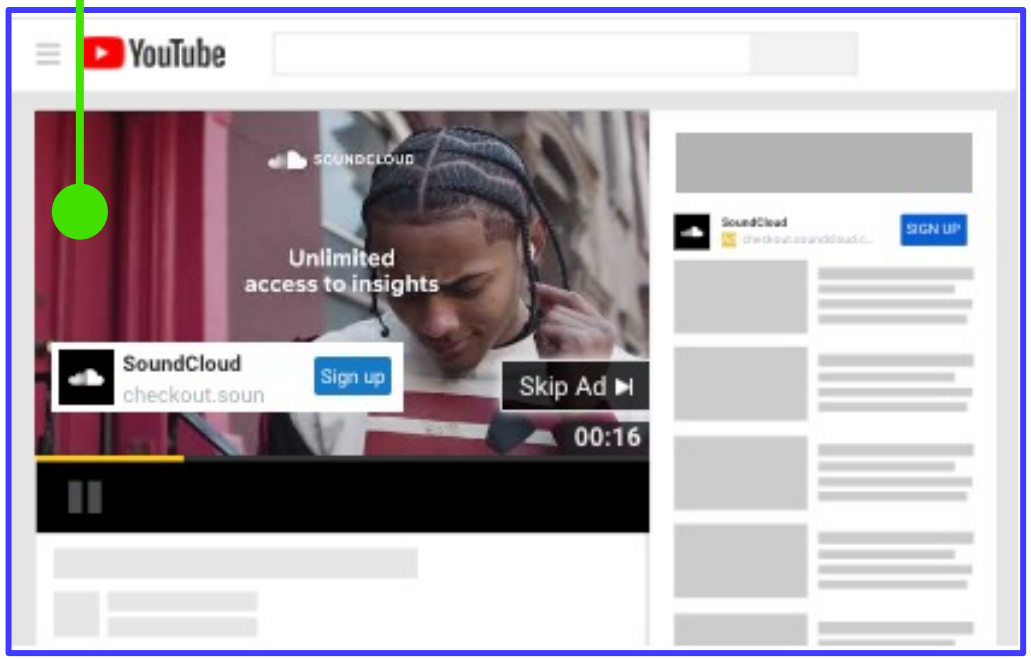
CREATIVE EXAMPLES

Varied creative to help optimize YouTube's algorithm







Audience-specific copy used to improve results

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THE POWER OF PERFORMANCE

-82%

DECREASE IN YOUTUBE ACQUISITION COSTS

-9%

UNDER GOAL FOR THE QUARTER

-45%

DECREASE IN CPV

This campaign ensured that YouTube turned around from the worst-performing channel to the most efficient acquisition campaign we had for our Artist initiatives. We implemented those new LAL and RTG audiences and saw CPAs drop over 82%, landing 9% under our client's goal for the quarter.

Q2 2022 vs. 2021 average

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TALK TO US

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